難聴(なんちょう)：前(まえ)から ゆっくり 話(はな)す

Hearing Loss — Face Him, Speak Slowly, Check He Understood — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Talk with a resident who cannot hear well: come round to the front before speaking, ask if he can hear, slow down instead of getting louder, use his better ear, check understanding with a question he must answer, and report a change in his hearing.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana (caregiver)

山田(やまだ)さん、おはようございます。

Good morning, Yamada-san.

Why: He does not turn round. That silence is your first information: he did not hear you, and he does not know you are in the room yet.

Yamada-san (resident)

え？ 何(なん)ですか。

Eh? What was that?

Why: He caught a sound, not the words. Do not repeat the same sentence from the same spot — change where you stand first.

Hana (caregiver)

お顔(かお)を 見(み)て 話(はな)しますね。

I'll talk to you face to face.

Why: THE RULE OF THIS EPISODE, first half. Come round to the front first. A resident with poor hearing reads your lips and face as much as he hears you — at his eye level, light on your face.

Hana (caregiver)

聞(き)こえますか。

Can you hear me?

Why: Ask it plainly, once. It tells him you have noticed, and it tells you where to start — it is care, not a test.

Yamada-san (resident)

よく 聞(き)こえません。

I can't hear very well.

Why: 難聴(なんちょう) — hearing loss — is very common in older residents, and many are embarrassed by it. He told you honestly; answer in a way that makes it safe to keep telling you.

Hana (caregiver)

では、ゆっくり 話(はな)しますね。

Then I'll speak slowly.

Why: THE RULE, second half. Slower and a little lower, not louder. Shouting breaks the sound apart and makes a kind sentence sound angry — and the whole corridor hears his business.

Hana (caregiver)

右(みぎ)と 左(ひだり)、どちらが 聞(き)こえますか。

Right or left — which ear hears better?

Why: Hearing is often better on one side. Ask once and remember it — then everyone on the shift can use his good side.

Yamada-san (resident)

右(みぎ)の 耳(みみ)が いいです。

My right ear is better.

Why: Now you know where to sit, where to stand at meals, and which side to speak from when you walk with him.

Hana (caregiver)

では、右(みぎ)から 話(はな)しますね。

Then I'll speak from your right side.

Why: Move to his good side and stay in front of him. Say what you are doing, so the move itself does not surprise him.

Hana (caregiver)

今日(きょう)は お風呂(ふろ)ですよ。

Today is your bath day.

Why: One short sentence, one idea. A long sentence gives him more words to lose — give the key word, then stop and let it land.

Yamada-san (resident)

お風呂(ふろ)ですか。

The bath?

Why: He repeats the key word back. That is a good sign — he caught it — so build on it with the next short piece.

Hana (caregiver)

はい。10時(じ)に 行(い)きましょう。

Yes. Let's go at ten.

Why: Numbers are the easiest thing to mishear. Say the time slowly, and hold up your fingers or point at the clock while you say it.

Hana (caregiver)

何時(なんじ)に 行(い)きますか。

So what time are we going?

Why: Check with a question he has to ANSWER. People who cannot hear well learn to nod to be polite, so a nod proves nothing — the time said back to you does.

Yamada-san (resident)

10時(じ)ですね。

At ten, right?

Why: Now you know he has it. If he had said a different time, you would say it again — slowly, from the front — never louder.

Hana (caregiver)

そうです。大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)ですよ。

That's right. You've got it.

Why: Confirm it warmly. A resident who is corrected all day stops trying to hear; one who is told he got it keeps trying.

Hana (caregiver)

また 聞(き)いてくださいね。

Just ask me again any time.

Why: Give him permission to ask. Many residents stay silent rather than ask twice — and silence is how a missed bath time or a missed pill happens.

Yamada-san (resident)

ありがとう。よく 分(わ)かりました。

Thank you. I understood that well.

Why: Slower and from the front did what shouting never could. He heard every word — and he kept his dignity while you said them.

Hana (caregiver)

耳(みみ)の ことは、すぐ 報告(ほうこく)します。

I'll report about your hearing straight away.

Why: A change in hearing can be earwax, an ear infection or a flat hearing-aid battery — all fixable. Tell the nurse today, and which ear is his good one.

2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	顔(かお)	*kao*	face	
2	話(はな)す	*hanasu*	to speak; talk	
3	聞(き)こえる	*kikoeru*	to be able to hear; be heard	
4	ゆっくり	*yukkuri*	slowly; without rushing (recycled from Ep 23)	
5	右(みぎ)	*migi*	right (side)	
6	左(ひだり)	*hidari*	left (side)	
7	耳(みみ)	*mimi*	ear	
8	お風呂(ふろ)	*ofuro*	bath	

9	行(い)く	*iku*	to go	
10	何時(なんじ)	*nanji*	what time	
11	大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)	*daijoubu*	okay; all right (recycled from Ep 23)	
12	分(わ)かる	*wakaru*	to understand	
13	報告(ほうこく)する	*houkokusuru*	to report (recycled from Ep 23)	

3 · Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
お顔(かお)を 見(み)て 話(はな)しますね	Come round to the front — face to face
聞(き)こえますか	Ask plainly whether he can hear you
ゆっくり 話(はな)しますね	Slower and lower — never louder
何時(なんじ)に 行(い)きますか	Check with a question he must answer, not a nod
耳(みみ)の ことは、すぐ 報告(ほうこく)します	A change in hearing is reported the same day

4 · Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does Yamada-san say about his ears? A) 右(みぎ)の 耳(みみ)が いいです B) 左(ひだり)の 耳(みみ)が いいです C) よく 聞(き)こえます D) 耳(みみ)が 痛(いた)いです	
2	What time is the bath? A) 8時(じ) B) 9時(じ) C) 10時(じ) D) 12時(じ)	
3	Ask him whether he can hear you.	
4	Tell him you'll talk to him face to face.	
5	Tell him to just ask you again any time.	

5 · Answer Key — こたえ

1. 右(みぎ)の 耳(みみ)が いいです。
2. はい。10時(じ)に 行(い)きましょう。
3. 聞(き)こえますか。
4. お顔(かお)を 見(み)て 話(はな)しますね。
5. また 聞(き)いてくださいね。